Who Helps Mom and How to Reach Them

The family's contacts and care notes in one place: where each is kept, how recent it is, and what hasn't been collected yet.

Her doctor's number is in Mom's address book, the neighbor's is in your sister's phone, and nobody is sure where the notes from her last appointment went.

This page doesn't ask you to read or understand any of it. It asks who is involved, how to reach them, where each note is kept and how recent it is. Ask Mom before you copy anything of hers.

WHAT TO COLLECT	WHERE IT IS	ITS DATE	WHO HAS IT
Mom's address and phone numbers			
Family members: names and phone numbers			
Neighbors and friends who help, and how to reach them			
Her doctors and her pharmacy, with phone numbers			
Other professionals or services she already uses			
The list of who does what for her, if one has been written			
Notes from her recent appointments			
Other notes someone keeps: a calendar, a notebook, a list on the fridge			
The family's own notes about her week			
Mom's say-so to gather and share these: who asked her, and when			

What we haven't collected yet, and who will ask

Anything above with an empty line. Put a name next to each. There's no deadline.

FOR EXAMPLE Nobody has the pharmacy's number. Karen will ask Mom on Thursday.

How to use it

- Ask Mom first. Her address book and her appointment notes are hers, and she decides what is shared and with whom.

- Write the date on each note or list as you find it. If it has no date, write “undated.”
- Don't copy out or summarize a note here. Just say where it is and who has it.
- Tell the family where this page is kept.

What this page doesn't do

It doesn't explain what any note or record means. If something in a note isn't clear, that's a question for the person who wrote it. An empty line is only something not collected yet.

Ready for the next step?

You know who is involved, how to reach them, where the notes are kept and what's still to collect. The care interview uses what you've gathered: it asks about Mom's situation area by area and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Keeping one list of contacts for doctors and neighbors, with a column for where each thing is kept, follows AARP's Prepare to Care guide. The rows come from the Family Care Roadmap's working list for this step.

1. AARP, Prepare to Care: A Planning Guide for Families